

Levi Skye Morris

Technical executive · Engineering leader · Systems architect

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Technical executive and hands-on engineering leader with 11+ years building customer-facing products and infrastructure in financial technology, healthcare, e-commerce, and distributed systems. Promoted from senior engineer to CTO; led a globally distributed organization through growth, banking and regulatory disruption, and an orderly wind-down, while staying close to architecture, reliability, and the hardest technical problems.

CORE STRENGTHS

Leadership

Technical strategy, organization design, hiring, coaching, performance management, distributed teams, and cross-functional partnership.

Systems

Payments and settlement, customer-facing applications, platform reliability, performance engineering, sensitive data, and applied cryptography.

Operations

Regulated environments, incident response, crisis management, organizational change, and responsible wind-downs.

EXPERIENCE

SpankChain

Remote · 2019–2026

Chief Technology Officer Jul 2020–Apr 2026

Acting Head of Engineering Dec 2019–Jul 2020

Senior Software Engineer Apr 2019–Dec 2019

- Promoted from senior engineer to CTO. Led an 8–10-person engineering organization across five countries and a 10-person contracted product team in Argentina; together the teams built and operated three distinct products.
- Owned recruiting, hiring, onboarding, coaching, performance management, workforce planning, and organizational change across internal and contracted product teams.
- Set technical direction across customer-facing applications, backend services, payment workflows, data systems, and blockchain infrastructure, and stayed hands-on for the hardest implementation and production problems.
- Partnered with product designers and commercial stakeholders to define user flows, settle product and technical tradeoffs, and carry customer-facing features from concept to production; without a dedicated project manager, ran delivery planning, dependencies, and risk for engineering initiatives.
- Owned payment and settlement systems processing seven figures in transaction volume, including banking integrations, KYC/AML controls, GDPR/CCPA compliance and federal age- and identity-verification recordkeeping (18 U.S.C. § 2257), along with security, reliability and incident response.
- Maintained Ethereum payment-channel infrastructure, working across signing, key management and Keccak hashing in Solidity, Vyper and JavaScript; used Python to parse complex smart-contract state from the Ethereum blockchain; stood up Keycloak as the identity and access layer for v2 of the payments platform.
- Maintained 99.9% platform uptime through the loss of banking partners, product de-platforming, and shifting regulatory requirements; retained roughly 80% of the core team through a major product sunset and restructuring.
- Led the technical wind-down of the company: kept security and access controls intact through staff reductions, archived regulated data, advised leadership on the handoff of intellectual property and modeled the economics of recovering six-figure residual balances from retired payment-channel contracts against on-chain gas costs.

CampSpot

Denver, Colorado · 2017–2019

Senior Software Engineer Sep 2017–Feb 2019

- Architected and built a PCI DSS Level 1 payment gateway, including third-party processor integrations, transaction workflows, failure handling and AES-256 encryption of cardholder data.
- Built and scaled customer-facing reservation and payment systems with Java, Kotlin, TypeScript, Dropwizard, Node.js, MySQL, and React.

DocNetwork / CampDoc

Ann Arbor, Michigan · 2015–2017

Development Team Lead Aug 2015–Jun 2017

- Led a 3–5-person team building a HIPAA/FERPA-compliant electronic health record and registration platform for pediatric and educational organizations.
- Led engineering as monthly payment volume grew from six to seven figures, balancing delivery against privacy, security, data integrity, and operational health.

- Resolved severe PostgreSQL performance bottlenecks through query-plan analysis, indexing, recursive CTEs, and data-model changes.
- Built product features end to end, from requirements to production, with TypeScript, Node.js, and Angular.

SearchSpring

Colorado Springs, Colorado · 2014–2015

Integration Specialist Nov 2014–Aug 2015

- Built production e-commerce search integrations for Shopify, Magento, NetSuite, and BigCommerce.
- Built pipelines that extracted client inventory and catalog data into S3 and indexed it into Elasticsearch, with custom relevance weighting for embedded SaaS search; diagnosed integration and production issues across the ELK stack.

Gelada Research Project

Simien Mountains, Ethiopia · 2012–2014

Field Site Manager Jun 2012–Jan 2014

- Ran personnel, logistics, safety, budgets, and research data collection at a remote, high-altitude primate field station under tight operational, financial, and physical constraints.

SELECTED WORK

Wildfire risk and edge photogrammetry

2026

Technical and business exploration

- Evaluated a localized wildfire-risk assessment service for real estate and insurance, integrating structural, topographic, vegetation, and Home Ignition Zone observations.
- Designed an edge-computing photogrammetry architecture with combined UAV and on-foot data collection for rapid 3D reconstruction and field risk reporting.
- Built a reporting pipeline that turns structured field observations into conservative, plain-language risk assessments, using constrained local inference checked by an independent auditing agent.

Computational ecology

2026

Clojure, Python and scientific computing

- Implemented configurable Ricker population models in Clojure with automated equilibrium and cycle detection, Lyapunov exponent estimation, bifurcation analysis, and Vega-Lite visualizations.
- Building stochastic population and eco-evolutionary models in Python with NumPy and SciPy, with attention to vectorization, preallocated fixed-size arrays and amortized array growth for performance.

TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Java, Kotlin, Clojure, Python, SQL, Solidity, Vyper, R

Product and web: React, Angular, Vue, Node.js, NestJS, Express, Dropwizard, REST, GraphQL, HTML, CSS

Data: PostgreSQL (JSONB, HSTORE), MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana, S3-based data lakes

Infrastructure: AWS (S3, EC2, EKS, Lambda, RDS/Aurora, KMS, IAM, CloudFront); GCP (GKE, Cloud Run, BigQuery, Pub/Sub, Cloud SQL); Cloudflare (Workers, WAF, DDoS protection); Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, Linux, KVM/QEMU

Delivery and observability: Git, GitHub Actions, Buildkite, Jenkins, CI/CD pipelines, Datadog, New Relic, Prometheus, Graylog

AI and agentic systems: Claude, GPT, Gemini, Gemma, Qwen; Claude Code, Codex (CLI and IDE), OpenCode, Cline/Roo Code, LiteLLM, Ollama, MTPLX; multi-model agentic workflows with cost- and privacy-aware routing between frontier APIs and self-hosted models; constrained generation with independent auditing agents

Security and cryptography: AES-256 and field-level encryption of cardholder data and SSNs, key management, digital signatures, salted hashing (bcrypt), Keccak/SHA-family hashing, in-house authentication systems, Keycloak

Risk and compliance: PCI DSS Level 1, HIPAA, FERPA, KYC/AML, GDPR/CCPA, 18 U.S.C. § 2257 recordkeeping; security, privacy and incident response

EDUCATION AND RECOGNITION

University of Michigan · B.S., Evolutionary Anthropology · 2012

National Science Foundation · Graduate Research Fellowship Program, Honorable Mention · 2014